



make the plan more explanatory considering i am not that used to supabase sql backend frontend you can give me each step by step guide in detail, not necessary to change first 3 4 days of week 1. just explain what to do at each step

Now I'll create a more detailed, beginner-friendly version of the development plan with step-by-step explanations for each task, focusing on Days 5 onwards since you mentioned the first 3-4 days are fine.

EcoGuardian: Detailed Step-by-Step Development Plan

This enhanced guide explains each task in detail, assuming you're new to Supabase, SQL, backend, and frontend development.^[1]

Week 1: Setup & Planning

Days 1-4: *Keep as is in original plan*

Day 5 (Friday) - API Keys Setup

⌚ 30 minutes

What You're Doing:

Setting up secure access to external services (OpenAI and Google Vision) that your app will use to analyze receipts and generate challenges.^[1]

Step-by-Step Guide:

Step 1: Get OpenAI API Key (10 mins)

1. Go to platform.openai.com and create an account
2. Click your profile icon (top right) → "View API Keys"
3. Click "Create new secret key"

4. **Important:** Copy the key immediately (it only shows once) and paste it in a temporary notepad
5. This key allows your app to generate AI challenges

Step 2: Enable Google Cloud Vision API (15 mins)

1. Go to console.cloud.google.com
2. Create a new project called "EcoGuardian"
3. In the search bar, type "Vision API" and enable it
4. Go to "Credentials" → "Create Credentials" → "API Key"
5. Copy this key - it allows your app to read text from receipt images (OCR = Optical Character Recognition)

Step 3: Create .env File (5 mins)

1. In VS Code, open your ecoguardian project folder
2. Right-click in the file explorer → "New File" → name it `.env`
3. Paste this template:

```
REACT_APP_SUPABASE_URL=your_supabase_project_url
REACT_APP_SUPABASE_KEY=your_supabase_anon_key
REACT_APP_OPENAI_KEY=your_openai_key
REACT_APP_GOOGLE_VISION_KEY=your_google_vision_key
```

4. Replace each `your_*` with the actual keys you copied
5. Find Supabase keys: Go to your Supabase project → Settings → API → Copy "Project URL" and "anon public" key

Step 4: Secure Your Keys

1. Create/open `.gitignore` file in your project root
2. Add this line: `.env`
3. This prevents your secret keys from being uploaded to GitHub (where hackers could steal them)

Why This Matters: API keys are like passwords for services. Keeping them in `.env` means you can use them in your code without exposing them publicly.^[1]

Checkpoint: All 4 keys stored in `.env` file, `.env` added to `.gitignore`

Days 6-7 (Weekend) - OFF

Optional: Watch beginner tutorials on React and Supabase to build confidence.^[1]

Week 2: Authentication & Basic UI

Day 8 (Monday) - Install Dependencies

▮ 30 minutes

What You're Doing:

Installing tools (libraries) that help you style your app (Tailwind CSS) and connect to your database (Supabase client).^[1]

Step-by-Step Guide:

Step 1: Install Tailwind CSS (15 mins)

1. Open terminal in VS Code (View → Terminal)
2. Make sure you're in the `ecoguardian` folder
3. Run: `npm install -D tailwindcss postcss autoprefixer`
4. Run: `npx tailwindcss init -p`
 - This creates `tailwind.config.js` file
5. Open `tailwind.config.js` and replace content with:

```
module.exports = {
  content: [
    "./src/**/*.{js,jsx,ts,tsx}",
  ],
  theme: {
    extend: {},
  },
  plugins: [],
}
```

6. Open `src/index.css` and replace everything with:

```
@tailwind base;
@tailwind components;
@tailwind utilities;
```

What This Does: Tailwind CSS lets you style elements using class names instead of writing custom CSS. For example, `<div className="bg-blue-500 p-4">` creates a blue background with padding.^[1]

Step 2: Install Supabase Client (10 mins)

1. In terminal, run: `npm install @supabase/supabase-js`
2. This library helps your React app talk to your Supabase database

Step 3: Create Supabase Connection File (5 mins)

1. In `src` folder, create new file: `supabaseClient.js`

2. Paste this code:

```
import { createClient } from '@supabase/supabase-js'

const supabaseUrl = process.env.REACT_APP_SUPABASE_URL
const supabaseKey = process.env.REACT_APP_SUPABASE_KEY

export const supabase = createClient(supabaseUrl, supabaseKey)
```

3. This creates a connection to your database that you can import anywhere in your app

Testing:

1. Open `src/App.js`

2. Add test div: `<div className="bg-green-500 text-white p-4">Tailwind Works!</div>`

3. Run `npm start`

4. You should see a green box with white text

Checkpoint: Tailwind showing styled elements, Supabase client ready to use. ^[1]

Day 9 (Tuesday) - Supabase Authentication Setup

▮ 60 minutes

What You're Doing:

Setting up a system where users can create accounts and log in to your app. Supabase handles all the security for you. ^[1]

Step-by-Step Guide:

Step 1: Configure Supabase Auth Dashboard (10 mins)

1. Go to your Supabase project dashboard
2. Click "Authentication" in left sidebar
3. Click "Providers" tab
4. Email is already enabled - this allows email/password login
5. Optional: Enable Google OAuth
 - Toggle "Google" on
 - Follow instructions to get Google Client ID and Secret from Google Cloud Console
 - Paste them in and Save

What This Does: Enables user authentication methods. Email = users sign up with email/password. Google = users sign in with Google account. ^[1]

Step 2: Create Login Component (20 mins)

1. In `src`, create folder called `components`
2. Inside, create file: `Login.js`
3. Paste this starter code:

```
import { useState } from 'react'
import { supabase } from '../supabaseClient'

function Login() {
  const [email, setEmail] = useState('')
  const [password, setPassword] = useState('')
  const [loading, setLoading] = useState(false)

  const handleLogin = async (e) => {
    e.preventDefault()
    setLoading(true)

    const { data, error } = await supabase.auth.signInWithPassword({
      email,
      password
    })

    if (error) {
      alert('Error: ' + error.message)
    } else {
      alert('Login successful!')
    }
    setLoading(false)
  }

  return (
    <form onSubmit={handleLogin} className="p-8 max-w-md mx-auto">
      <h2 className="text-2xl mb-4">Login</h2>
      <input
        type="email"
        placeholder="Email"
        value={email}
        onChange={e => setEmail(e.target.value)}
        className="border p-2 w-full mb-4"
      />
      <input
        type="password"
        placeholder="Password"
        value={password}
        onChange={e => setPassword(e.target.value)}
        className="border p-2 w-full mb-4"
      />
      <button
        type="submit"
        disabled={loading}
        className="bg-blue-500 text-white p-2 w-full"
      >
        {loading ? 'Loading...' : 'Login'}
      </button>
    </form>
  )
}
```

```

    </form>
  )
}

export default Login

```

Code Explanation:

- `useState`: Creates variables that can change (email, password, loading state)
- `handleLogin`: Function that runs when form submits
- `supabase.auth.signInWithPassword`: Supabase function that checks if email/password match
- `e.preventDefault()`: Stops page from refreshing when form submits
- **Frontend** = the form you see; **Backend** = Supabase checking password

Step 3: Create Signup Component (15 mins)

1. Create `Signup.js` in components folder
2. Similar to Login, but use `supabase.auth.signUp()` instead
3. Ask Copilot: "Create React signup component using Supabase auth"

Step 4: Add to App.js (10 mins)

1. Open `src/App.js`
2. Import Login: `import Login from './components/Login'`
3. Replace content with: `<Login />`
4. Run `npm start` and test

Step 5: Test Authentication (5 mins)

1. Try creating an account with your email
2. Check Supabase dashboard → Authentication → Users
3. You should see your test user listed

What Happened Behind the Scenes:

- Supabase stored your email and encrypted password in the database
- When you log in, Supabase checks if the password matches
- If correct, Supabase sends back a "session token" proving you're logged in
- **SQL** (Structured Query Language) is how Supabase stores/retrieves data, but you don't write it directly - Supabase handles it

Checkpoint: Can create test user and successfully log in. ^[1]

Day 10 (Wednesday) - Login/Signup UI

⌚ 45 minutes

What You're Doing:

Making your login page look professional and modern using Tailwind CSS styling.^[1]

Step-by-Step Guide:

Step 1: Improve Form Styling (20 mins)

1. Ask Copilot: "Create modern login form with Tailwind CSS including email, password fields, and submit button"
2. Replace your Login.js form section with the generated styled version
3. Common Tailwind classes to understand:
 - `flex`: Arranges items in a row/column
 - `items-center`: Centers items vertically
 - `justify-center`: Centers items horizontally
 - `bg-gradient-to-r from-blue-500 to-green-500`: Gradient background
 - `rounded-lg`: Rounded corners
 - `shadow-xl`: Drop shadow effect

Step 2: Add Toggle Between Login/Signup (15 mins)

1. Create `Auth.js` that contains both Login and Signup
2. Use a button to toggle between views:

```
const [isLogin, setIsLogin] = useState(true)

return (
  <div>
    {isLogin ? <Login /> : <Signup />}
    <button onClick={() => setIsLogin(!isLogin)}>
      {isLogin ? 'Need an account? Sign up' : 'Have an account? Login'}
    </button>
  </div>
)
```

Step 3: Optional - Add Google OAuth Button (10 mins)

1. Add this function to your Login component:

```
const handleGoogleLogin = async () => {
  const { data, error } = await supabase.auth.signInWithOAuth({
    provider: 'google'
  })
}
```

2. Add button: `<button onClick={handleGoogleLogin}>Sign in with Google</button>`

3. Style it with Tailwind

What "OAuth" Means: Instead of creating a new password, users click "Sign in with Google" and Google confirms their identity to your app.^[1]

Checkpoint: Beautiful, professional-looking login page that works.^[1]

Day 11 (Thursday) - Dashboard Layout

▮ 60 minutes

What You're Doing:

Creating the main page users see after logging in, with sections for stats, upload button, and leaderboard.^[1]

Step-by-Step Guide:

Step 1: Create Dashboard Component (15 mins)

1. Create `Dashboard.js` in components folder

2. Basic structure:

```
function Dashboard() {
  return (
    <div className="min-h-screen bg-gray-100">
      <nav className="bg-white shadow p-4">
        <h1 className="text-2xl font-bold">EcoGuardian</h1>
      </nav>

      <div className="container mx-auto p-4">
        <div className="grid grid-cols-1 md:grid-cols-3 gap-4">
          {/* Stats Card */}
          <div className="bg-white p-6 rounded shadow">
            <h3>Your Carbon Footprint</h3>
            <p className="text-3xl font-bold">0 kg CO2</p>
          </div>

          {/* Upload Section */}
          <div className="bg-white p-6 rounded shadow">
            <h3>Upload Receipt</h3>
            <button className="bg-green-500 text-white p-2 rounded">
              Upload
            </button>
          </div>

          {/* Leaderboard Preview */}
          <div className="bg-white p-6 rounded shadow">
            <h3>Leaderboard</h3>
            <p>Coming soon...</p>
          </div>
        </div>
      </div>
    </div>
  )
}
```



```

    </div>
  </div>
)
}

```

Layout Explanation:

- `grid grid-cols-1 md:grid-cols-3`: 1 column on mobile, 3 columns on desktop
- `gap-4`: Space between grid items
- Each div with `bg-white p-6 rounded shadow` is a "card"
- **Frontend** = this visual layout; it doesn't do anything yet, just shows structure

Step 2: Add Sidebar Navigation (20 mins)

1. Add a sidebar with links:

```

<aside className="w-64 bg-white shadow-lg h-screen fixed">
  <nav className="p-4">
    <ul>
      <li className="mb-4"><a href="#dashboard">Dashboard</a></li>
      <li className="mb-4"><a href="#upload">Upload</a></li>
      <li className="mb-4"><a href="#leaderboard">Leaderboard</a></li>
      <li className="mb-4"><a href="#challenges">Challenges</a></li>
    </ul>
  </nav>
</aside>

```

2. Adjust main content to not overlap sidebar: `<div className="ml-64">`

Step 3: Add User Profile Section (15 mins)

1. Get logged-in user info from Supabase:

```

import { useEffect, useState } from 'react'
import { supabase } from '../supabaseClient'

function Dashboard() {
  const [user, setUser] = useState(null)

  useEffect(() => {
    getUser()
  }, [])

  const getUser = async () => {
    const { data: { user } } = await supabase.auth.getUser()
    setUser(user)
  }

  return (
    <div>
      <p>Welcome, {user?.email}</p>
      { /* rest of dashboard */ }
    </div>
  )
}

```

```
)  
}
```

What `useEffect` Does: Runs code when component loads. Here it fetches the logged-in user's information.^[1]

Step 4: Make It Responsive (10 mins)

1. Test dashboard on different screen sizes (Chrome DevTools → Toggle device toolbar)
2. Adjust Tailwind classes for mobile: `md:` prefix means "on medium screens and up"

Checkpoint: Dashboard skeleton visible after login with placeholder sections.^[1]

Day 12 (Friday) - Protected Routes

⌚ 45 minutes

What You're Doing:

Making sure only logged-in users can see the Dashboard. If not logged in, automatically redirect to Login page.^[1]

Step-by-Step Guide:

Step 1: Install React Router (5 mins)

1. Run: `npm install react-router-dom`
2. This library manages different pages/URLs in your app

Step 2: Set Up Routes (15 mins)

1. Open `App.js`
2. Replace with:

```
import { BrowserRouter, Routes, Route } from 'react-router-dom'  
import Login from './components/Login'  
import Dashboard from './components/Dashboard'  
  
function App() {  
  return (  
    <BrowserRouter>  
      <Routes>  
        <Route path="/" element={<Login />} />  
        <Route path="/dashboard" element={<Dashboard />} />  
      </Routes>  
    </BrowserRouter>  
  )  
}
```

What This Means:

- / (homepage) shows Login
- /dashboard shows Dashboard
- But anyone can go to /dashboard right now - we need to protect it!

Step 3: Create Protected Route Component (20 mins)

1. Create ProtectedRoute.js:

```
import { useEffect, useState } from 'react'
import { Navigate } from 'react-router-dom'
import { supabase } from '../supabaseClient'

function ProtectedRoute({ children }) {
  const [user, setUser] = useState(null)
  const [loading, setLoading] = useState(true)

  useEffect(() => {
    checkUser()
  }, [])

  const checkUser = async () => {
    const { data: { user } } = await supabase.auth.getUser()
    setUser(user)
    setLoading(false)
  }

  if (loading) {
    return <div>Loading...</div>
  }

  if (!user) {
    return <Navigate to="/" /> // Redirect to login
  }

  return children // Show protected page
}

export default ProtectedRoute
```

2. Update App.js:

```
<Route
  path="/dashboard"
  element={
    <ProtectedRoute>
      <Dashboard />
    </ProtectedRoute>
  }
/>
```

How It Works:

1. When user visits /dashboard, ProtectedRoute checks if they're logged in

2. If not logged in: redirect to / (login page)
3. If logged in: show Dashboard
4. This is **authentication** - checking who you are
5. Supabase handles the backend checking; your React code handles the frontend redirecting

Step 4: Add Logout Button (5 mins)

1. In Dashboard, add:

```
const handleLogout = async () => {  
  await supabase.auth.signOut()  
  window.location.href = '/'  
}  
  
// In JSX:  
<button onClick={handleLogout}>Logout</button>
```

Checkpoint: Can only access dashboard when logged in; automatically redirected to login if not. ^[1]

Days 13-14 (Weekend) - OFF

Rest and review what you've learned about authentication and routing. ^[1]

Week 3: Core Features

Day 15 (Monday) - Receipt Upload UI

▮ 45 minutes

What You're Doing:

Creating an interface where users can select or drag-and-drop receipt images. ^[1]

Step-by-Step Guide:

Step 1: Create Upload Component (15 mins)

1. Create ReceiptUpload.js:

```
import { useState } from 'react'  
  
function ReceiptUpload() {  
  const [selectedFile, setSelectedFile] = useState(null)  
  const [preview, setPreview] = useState(null)  
  
  const handleFileSelect = (e) => {  
    const file = e.target.files[0]  
    setSelectedFile(file)
```

```

    // Create preview
    const reader = new FileReader()
    reader.onloadend = () => {
      setPreview(reader.result)
    }
    reader.readAsDataURL(file)
  }

  return (
    <div className="p-8">
      <input
        type="file"
        accept="image/*"
        onChange={handleFileSelect}
        className="mb-4"
      />

      {preview && (
        <img src={preview} alt="Preview" className="max-w-md" />
      )}
    </div>
  )
}

```

What's Happening:

- `<input type="file">`: Native browser file picker
- `FileReader`: Browser API that reads the file and converts it to a displayable image
- `readAsDataURL`: Converts image file to a string (data URL) that can be shown in `<img>` tag
- This is all **frontend** - the file is only in the user's browser so far

Step 2: Add Drag-and-Drop (20 mins)

1. Ask Copilot: "React file upload component with drag and drop"
2. Add drag event handlers:

```

const handleDrop = (e) => {
  e.preventDefault()
  const file = e.dataTransfer.files[0]
  // Process file same as handleFileSelect
}

const handleDragOver = (e) => {
  e.preventDefault()
}

// In JSX:
<div
  onDrop={handleDrop}
  onDragOver={handleDragOver}
  className="border-2 border-dashed p-8"
>

```

```
Drag receipt here or click to upload
</div>
```

Step 3: Add to Dashboard (10 mins)

1. Import ReceiptUpload in Dashboard
2. Replace upload placeholder section with <ReceiptUpload />

Checkpoint: Can select receipt images and see preview before uploading.^[1]

Day 16 (Tuesday) - Google Vision API Integration

▮ 60 minutes

What You're Doing:

Connecting to Google Vision API to extract text from receipt images (OCR = reading text from images).^[1]

Step-by-Step Guide:

Step 1: Install Google Vision Library (5 mins)

1. Run: `npm install @google-cloud/vision`
2. This library handles communication with Google's servers

Step 2: Create OCR Function (25 mins)

1. Create `utils` folder in `src`
2. Create `ocrService.js`:

```
export const extractTextFromImage = async (imageFile) => {
  // Convert image to base64
  const reader = new FileReader()

  return new Promise((resolve, reject) => {
    reader.onloadend = async () => {
      const base64Image = reader.result.split(',')[^1]

      try {
        // Call Google Vision API
        const response = await fetch(
          `https://vision.googleapis.com/v1/images:annotate?key=${process.env.REACT_APP_GOOGLE_VISION_API_KEY}`
        )
        {
          method: 'POST',
          headers: { 'Content-Type': 'application/json' },
          body: JSON.stringify({
            requests: [{
              image: { content: base64Image },
              features: [{ type: 'TEXT_DETECTION' }]
            }]
          })
        }
      }
    }
  })
}
```

```

        }
    )

    const data = await response.json()
    const text = data.responses[0].fullTextAnnotation.text
    resolve(text)
  } catch (error) {
    reject(error)
  }
}

reader.readAsDataURL(imageFile)
})
}

```

Breaking It Down:

- **Base64:** Converts image to text format that can be sent over internet
- **fetch:** Sends HTTP request to Google's servers
- **POST method:** Sending data (your image) to Google
- **Promise:** JavaScript way of handling asynchronous operations (waiting for Google's response)
- **Backend:** Google Vision API is the backend service analyzing your image

Step 3: Add to Upload Component (20 mins)

1. Update ReceiptUpload.js:

```

import { extractTextFromImage } from '../utils/ocrService'

const handleUpload = async () => {
  if (!selectedFile) return

  setLoading(true)
  try {
    const extractedText = await extractTextFromImage(selectedFile)
    console.log('Extracted text:', extractedText)
    alert('Text extracted! Check console.')
  } catch (error) {
    console.error('OCR Error:', error)
    alert('Error extracting text')
  }
  setLoading(false)
}

// Add upload button:
<button onClick={handleUpload}>Analyze Receipt</button>

```

Step 4: Test with Sample Receipt (10 mins)

1. Find a clear receipt image online or take photo of real receipt
2. Upload it to your app

3. Click "Analyze Receipt"
4. Check browser console (F12 → Console tab) to see extracted text

What Happened:

1. **Frontend:** Your React app selected the image
2. **API Call:** Sent image to Google's **backend** servers
3. **Backend Processing:** Google AI read the text from image
4. **Response:** Google sent back the text
5. **Frontend:** Your app displayed the text

Checkpoint: Can extract text from receipt images. ^[1]

Day 17 (Wednesday) - Carbon Dataset Setup

⌚ 45 minutes

What You're Doing:

Getting a database of products and their carbon footprints, so you can match receipt items to their environmental impact. ^[1]

Step-by-Step Guide:

Step 1: Find Carbon Dataset (15 mins)

1. Search for "open source carbon footprint dataset CSV"
2. Recommended sources from the plan: ClimateIQ, OpenCarbonDatabase ^[1]
3. Download a CSV file with columns like:
 - Product Name
 - Category (Meat, Dairy, Vegetables, etc.)
 - Carbon Footprint (kg CO2 per kg of product)
4. Example data:

```
Product,Category,C02_per_kg
Beef,Meat,27
Chicken,Meat,6.9
Milk,Dairy,1.9
Tomatoes,Vegetables,2.1
```

Step 2: Add to Project (10 mins)

1. In `src`, create folder called `data`
2. Place your CSV file there, name it `carbon_data.csv`
3. Install CSV parser: `npm install papaparse`

Step 3: Create Parser Function (20 mins)

1. Create `src/utils/carbonData.js`:

```
import Papa from 'papaparse'
import carbonCSV from '../data/carbon_data.csv'

export const loadCarbonData = async () => {
  return new Promise((resolve, reject) => {
    Papa.parse(carbonCSV, {
      download: true,
      header: true,
      complete: (results) => {
        resolve(results.data)
      },
      error: (error) => {
        reject(error)
      }
    })
  })
}

// Function to search for product
export const findProductCarbon = (productName, carbonData) => {
  // Simple search - will improve with fuzzy matching later
  const product = carbonData.find(item =>
    item.Product.toLowerCase().includes(productName.toLowerCase())
  )
  return product ? parseFloat(product.CO2_per_kg) : null
}
```

What This Does:

- **Papa.parse**: Reads CSV file and converts to JavaScript array of objects
- **loadCarbonData**: Loads the entire dataset into memory
- **findProductCarbon**: Searches dataset for a product name
- This is **data processing** on the frontend (in the browser)

Step 4: Test Loading Data (5 mins)

1. In Dashboard, add:

```
import { loadCarbonData } from '../utils/carbonData'

useEffect(() => {
  testLoad()
}, [])

const testLoad = async () => {
  const data = await loadCarbonData()
  console.log('Loaded', data.length, 'products')
}
```

Checkpoint: Can load and parse CSV carbon footprint data.^[1]

Day 18 (Thursday) - Carbon Calculation Logic

▮ 60 minutes

What You're Doing:

Matching items from the receipt text to products in your carbon dataset, calculating total footprint, and saving to Supabase database.^[1]

Step-by-Step Guide:

Step 1: Install Fuzzy Matching Library (5 mins)

1. Run: `npm install fuse.js`
2. This library helps match similar text (e.g., "chkn" matches "chicken")

Step 2: Improve Product Matching (25 mins)

1. Update `carbonData.js`:

```
import Fuse from 'fuse.js'

export const matchReceiptItems = (receiptText, carbonData) => {
  // Extract potential product names from receipt
  const lines = receiptText.split('\n')
  const items = []

  // Setup fuzzy search
  const fuse = new Fuse(carbonData, {
    keys: ['Product'],
    threshold: 0.4 // How fuzzy the match can be (0-1)
  })

  lines.forEach(line => {
    // Skip lines that are just numbers or dates
    if (/^\d+$/ .test(line) || line.length < 3) return

    // Search for product in dataset
    const results = fuse.search(line)
    if (results.length > 0) {
      const match = results[0].item
      items.push({
        name: line,
        matchedProduct: match.Product,
        carbonPerKg: parseFloat(match.CO2_per_kg),
        quantity: 1 // Default, can improve later
      })
    } else {
      // Item not found, use average value
      items.push({
        name: line,
```

```

        matchedProduct: 'Unknown',
        carbonPerKg: 5, // Average value
        quantity: 1
      })
    }
  })

  return items
}

export const calculateTotalCarbon = (items) => {
  return items.reduce((total, item) => {
    return total + (item.carbonPerKg * item.quantity)
  }, 0)
}

```

How Fuzzy Matching Works:

- Compares receipt text ("orgnic tomatoes") to dataset products ("Organic Tomatoes")
- Calculates similarity score
- Returns best match if score is above threshold
- **Frontend logic** processing data

Step 3: Save to Supabase (20 mins)

1. Create `src/utlis/databaseService.js`:

```

import { supabase } from '../supabaseClient'

export const saveReceipt = async (userId, imageUrl, items, totalCarbon) => {
  const { data, error } = await supabase
    .from('Receipts')
    .insert([
      {
        user_id: userId,
        image_url: imageUrl,
        items: JSON.stringify(items), // Convert array to text
        total_carbon: totalCarbon,
        date: new Date().toISOString()
      }
    ])
    .select()

  if (error) {
    console.error('Error saving receipt:', error)
    return null
  }

  return data[0]
}

export const updateUserTotalCarbon = async (userId, additionalCarbon) => {
  // Get current total
  const { data: userData } = await supabase
    .from('Users')

```

```

        .select('total_carbon')
        .eq('id', userId)
        .single()

const newTotal = (userData.total_carbon || 0) + additionalCarbon

// Update user's total
await supabase
    .from('Users')
    .update({ total_carbon: newTotal })
    .eq('id', userId)
}

```

Understanding Supabase Queries:

- `.from('Receipts')`: Which table to use (like **SQL** `SELECT * FROM Receipts`)
- `.insert([...])`: Add new row (**SQL** `INSERT INTO`)
- `.select()`: Return the inserted data
- `.eq('id', userId)`: Filter where id equals userId (**SQL** `WHERE id = userId`)
- **Supabase is the backend database**; this code is the frontend sending instructions

Step 4: Connect Everything (10 mins)

1. Update ReceiptUpload.js:

```

import { matchReceiptItems, calculateTotalCarbon } from '../utils/carbonData'
import { saveReceipt, updateUserTotalCarbon } from '../utils/databaseService'

const handleUpload = async () => {
    const extractedText = await extractTextFromImage(selectedFile)
    const carbonData = await loadCarbonData()
    const items = matchReceiptItems(extractedText, carbonData)
    const totalCarbon = calculateTotalCarbon(items)

    // Save to database
    const user = await supabase.auth.getUser()
    await saveReceipt(user.id, preview, items, totalCarbon)
    await updateUserTotalCarbon(user.id, totalCarbon)

    alert(`Total carbon footprint: ${totalCarbon.toFixed(2)} kg CO2`)
}

```

The Complete Flow:

1. **Frontend**: User uploads image
2. **API Call**: Image sent to Google Vision (backend)
3. **Frontend**: Text extracted from response
4. **Frontend**: Text matched to carbon dataset
5. **Frontend**: Carbon calculated
6. **Backend (Supabase)**: Data saved to database

7. **Frontend:** Confirmation shown to user

Checkpoint: Can calculate and save carbon footprint to Supabase.^[1]

Day 19 (Friday) - Display Results

▮ 45 minutes

What You're Doing:

Creating a nice display on the dashboard showing the carbon footprint results with item breakdown.^[1]

Step-by-Step Guide:

Step 1: Create Results Component (20 mins)

1. Create ReceiptResults.js:

```
function ReceiptResults({ items, totalCarbon }) {
  return (
    <div className="bg-white p-6 rounded-lg shadow">
      <h3 className="text-xl font-bold mb-4">Carbon Footprint Analysis</h3>

      <div className="mb-6">
        <div className="text-4xl font-bold text-red-600">
          {totalCarbon.toFixed(2)} kg CO2
        </div>
        <p className="text-gray-600">Total emissions from this purchase</p>
      </div>

      <h4 className="font-semibold mb-2">Item Breakdown:</h4>
      <div className="space-y-2">
        {items.map((item, index) => (
          <div key={index} className="flex justify-between border-b pb-2">
            <span>{item.name}</span>
            <span className="text-gray-600">
              {(item.carbonPerKg * item.quantity).toFixed(2)} kg CO2
            </span>
          </div>
        ))}
      </div>
    </div>
  )
}
```

Step 2: Fetch User's Receipts (15 mins)

1. In Dashboard, add function to load receipts:

```
const [receipts, setReceipts] = useState([])

useEffect(() => {
  loadReceipts()
```

```

}, [])

const loadReceipts = async () => {
  const { data: { user } } = await supabase.auth.getUser()

  const { data, error } = await supabase
    .from('Receipts')
    .select('*')
    .eq('user_id', user.id)
    .order('date', { ascending: false })
    .limit(5) // Show last 5 receipts

  if (data) {
    setReceipts(data)
  }
}

```

SQL Behind the Scenes:

- What Supabase runs: `SELECT * FROM Receipts WHERE user_id = '...' ORDER BY date DESC LIMIT 5`
- You don't write SQL directly; Supabase JavaScript library converts your code to SQL

Step 3: Display on Dashboard (10 mins)

1. Update Dashboard JSX:

```

<div className="grid grid-cols-1 md:grid-cols-2 gap-4">
  {receipts.map(receipt => {
    const items = JSON.parse(receipt.items)
    return (
      <ReceiptResults
        key={receipt.id}
        items={items}
        totalCarbon={receipt.total_carbon}
      />
    )
  })}
</div>

```

Checkpoint: Receipt analysis shows on dashboard with item-by-item breakdown. ^[1]

Days 20-21 (Weekend) - OFF / Catch-up

Use this time to fix bugs and review Week 3 concepts. ^[1]

Week 4: Social Features & Finalization

Day 22 (Monday) - Team Creation

⌚ 60 minutes

What You're Doing:

Allowing users to create teams and join others using invite codes, enabling group competition.^[1]

Step-by-Step Guide:

Step 1: Create Team Component (20 mins)

1. Create TeamManager.js:

```
import { useState } from 'react'
import { supabase } from '../supabaseClient'

function TeamManager() {
  const [teamName, setTeamName] = useState('')
  const [inviteCode, setInviteCode] = useState('')
  const [currentTeam, setCurrentTeam] = useState(null)

  const generateInviteCode = () => {
    // Generate random 6-character code
    const chars = 'ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ0123456789'
    let code = ''
    for (let i = 0; i < 6; i++) {
      code += chars[Math.floor(Math.random() * chars.length)]
    }
    return code
  }

  const createTeam = async () => {
    const code = generateInviteCode()
    const user = (await supabase.auth.getUser()).data.user

    // Insert team into database
    const { data: team, error } = await supabase
      .from('Teams')
      .insert([
        {
          name: teamName,
          invite_code: code,
          total_score: 0
        }
      ])
      .select()
      .single()

    if (error) {
      alert('Error creating team: ' + error.message)
      return
    }

    // Update user's team_id
```

```

    await supabase
      .from('Users')
      .update({ team_id: team.id })
      .eq('id', user.id)

    setCurrentTeam(team)
    alert(`Team created! Invite code: ${code}`)
  }

const joinTeam = async () => {
  const user = (await supabase.auth.getUser()).data.user

  // Find team by invite code
  const { data: team } = await supabase
    .from('Teams')
    .select('*')
    .eq('invite_code', inviteCode)
    .single()

  if (!team) {
    alert('Team not found!')
    return
  }

  // Update user's team_id
  await supabase
    .from('Users')
    .update({ team_id: team.id })
    .eq('id', user.id)

  setCurrentTeam(team)
  alert(`Joined team: ${team.name}`)
}

return (
  <div className="bg-white p-6 rounded-lg">
    {!currentTeam ? (
      <>
        <h3 className="text-xl font-bold mb-4">Create or Join Team</h3>

        <div className="mb-6">
          <h4 className="font-semibold mb-2">Create New Team</h4>
          <input
            type="text"
            placeholder="Team Name"
            value={teamName}
            onChange={e => setTeamName(e.target.value)}
            className="border p-2 w-full mb-2"
          />
          <button
            onClick={createTeam}
            className="bg-blue-500 text-white p-2 rounded w-full"
          >
            Create Team
          </button>
        </div>
      </>
    ) : (
      <div>
        <h3>Join Team</h3>
        <input
          type="text"
          placeholder="Invite Code"
          value={inviteCode}
          onChange={e => setInviteCode(e.target.value)}
          className="border p-2 w-full mb-2"
        />
        <button
          onClick={joinTeam}
          className="bg-blue-500 text-white p-2 rounded w-full"
        >
          Join Team
        </button>
      </div>
    )}
  </div>
)

```



```

        <div>
          <h4 className="font-semibold mb-2">Join Existing Team</h4>
          <input
            type="text"
            placeholder="Invite Code"
            value={inviteCode}
            onChange={e => setInviteCode(e.target.value.toUpperCase())}
            className="border p-2 w-full mb-2"
          />
          <button
            onClick={joinTeam}
            className="bg-green-500 text-white p-2 rounded w-full"
          >
            Join Team
          </button>
        </div>
      </>
    ) : (
      <div>
        <h3 className="text-xl font-bold">Your Team: {currentTeam.name}</h3>
        <p className="text-gray-600">Invite Code: {currentTeam.invite_code}</p>
      </div>
    )}
  </div>
)
}

```

How Invite Codes Work:

1. Random code generated (e.g., "ABC123")
2. Stored in Teams table with team info
3. Other users enter code to find the team
4. Their user record updated to link to that team
5. **Backend (Supabase)** stores relationships; **Frontend** handles UI

Step 2: Load User's Team on Dashboard (15 mins)

1. In Dashboard:

```

useEffect(() => {
  loadUserTeam()
}, [])

const loadUserTeam = async () => {
  const user = (await supabase.auth.getUser()).data.user

  const { data: userData } = await supabase
    .from('Users')
    .select('team_id')
    .eq('id', user.id)
    .single()

  if (userData.team_id) {

```

```

    const { data: team } = await supabase
      .from('Teams')
      .select('*')
      .eq('id', userData.team_id)
      .single()

    setTeam(team)
  }
}

```

Database Relationships:

- Users table has `team_id` column
- This links to Teams table's `id` column
- Called a **"foreign key"** in SQL terminology
- Allows finding which team a user belongs to

Step 3: Add to Dashboard (10 mins)

1. Import and display `<TeamManager />` in Dashboard

Checkpoint: Can create and join teams using invite codes.^[1]

Day 23 (Tuesday) - AI Challenge Generation

▮ 45 minutes

What You're Doing:

Using OpenAI's GPT to generate personalized weekly challenges based on team's carbon footprint.^[1]

Step-by-Step Guide:

Step 1: Create OpenAI Service (20 mins)

1. Create `src/utils/openaiService.js`:

```

export const generateChallenges = async (teamAvgCarbon, teamSize) => {
  const prompt = `Generate 3 actionable carbon-reduction challenges for a team of ${teamSize}
  - Specific and measurable
  - Achievable within one week
  - Related to food, transport, or consumption

  Format as JSON array with fields: title, description, points (10-50)`

  try {
    const response = await fetch('https://api.openai.com/v1/chat/completions', {
      method: 'POST',
      headers: {
        'Content-Type': 'application/json',
        'Authorization': `Bearer ${process.env.REACT_APP_OPENAI_KEY}`
      }
    })
  }
}

```

```

    },
    body: JSON.stringify({
      model: 'gpt-4',
      messages: [
        { role: 'system', content: 'You are an environmental coach.' },
        { role: 'user', content: prompt }
      ],
      temperature: 0.7
    })
  })

  const data = await response.json()
  const challengesText = data.choices[0].message.content

  // Parse JSON from GPT's response
  const challenges = JSON.parse(challengesText)
  return challenges
} catch (error) {
  console.error('OpenAI Error:', error)
  // Return default challenges if API fails
  return [
    {
      title: 'Reduce Meat Consumption',
      description: 'Have 2 vegetarian meals this week',
      points: 30
    },
    {
      title: 'Use Public Transport',
      description: 'Take bus/train instead of car 3 times',
      points: 25
    },
    {
      title: 'Buy Local',
      description: 'Purchase 5 local products instead of imported',
      points: 20
    }
  ]
}
}

```

How AI Generation Works:

1. **Frontend:** Creates prompt describing what challenges you want
2. **API Call:** Sends prompt to OpenAI's servers (backend)
3. **Backend (OpenAI):** GPT model generates text based on prompt
4. **Response:** OpenAI sends back generated challenges
5. **Frontend:** Parses and displays challenges

Step 2: Save Challenges to Database (15 mins)

1. Create function in databaseService.js:

```

export const saveChallenges = async (teamId, challenges) => {
  const challengeRecords = challenges.map(ch => ({
    team_id: teamId,
    description: ch.description,
    points: ch.points,
    completed: false,
    week: getCurrentWeek() // You'd implement this
  })))

  const { data, error } = await supabase
    .from('Challenges')
    .insert(challengeRecords)

  return { data, error }
}

```

Step 3: Display Challenges (10 mins)

1. Create Challenges.js component:

```

function Challenges({ teamId }) {
  const [challenges, setChallenges] = useState([])

  useEffect(() => {
    loadChallenges()
  }, [])

  const loadChallenges = async () => {
    const { data } = await supabase
      .from('Challenges')
      .select('*')
      .eq('team_id', teamId)
      .eq('week', getCurrentWeek())

    setChallenges(data || [])
  }

  const markCompleted = async (challengeId) => {
    await supabase
      .from('Challenges')
      .update({ completed: true })
      .eq('id', challengeId)

    loadChallenges() // Refresh
  }

  return (
    <div className="bg-white p-6 rounded-lg">
      <h3 className="text-xl font-bold mb-4">Weekly Challenges</h3>
      {challenges.map(ch => (
        <div key={ch.id} className="border-b pb-3 mb-3">
          <h4 className="font-semibold">{ch.description}</h4>
          <p className="text-sm text-gray-600">{ch.points} points</p>
          {!ch.completed && (
            <button

```

```

        onClick={() => markCompleted(ch.id)}
        className="bg-green-500 text-white px-3 py-1 rounded mt-2"
      >
        Mark Complete
      </button>
    )}
    {ch.completed && (
      <span className="text-green-600">✓ Completed</span>
    )}
  </div>
)}
</div>
)
}

```

Checkpoint: AI-generated challenges display on dashboard and can be marked complete.^[1]

Day 24 (Wednesday) - Leaderboard Component

▮ 60 minutes

What You're Doing:

Creating a leaderboard showing team/user rankings with real-time updates.^[1]

Step-by-Step Guide:

Step 1: Calculate Team Scores (15 mins)

1. Create function in databaseService.js:

```

export const calculateTeamScore = async (teamId) => {
  // Get all completed challenges for team
  const { data: challenges } = await supabase
    .from('Challenges')
    .select('points')
    .eq('team_id', teamId)
    .eq('completed', true)

  const totalPoints = challenges.reduce((sum, ch) => sum + ch.points, 0)

  // Update team's total_score
  await supabase
    .from('Teams')
    .update({ total_score: totalPoints })
    .eq('id', teamId)

  return totalPoints
}

```

Step 2: Create Leaderboard Component (25 mins)

1. Create Leaderboard.js:

```

import { useState, useEffect } from 'react'
import { supabase } from '../supabaseClient'

function Leaderboard() {
  const [teams, setTeams] = useState([])

  useEffect(() => {
    loadLeaderboard()

    // Setup real-time subscription
    const subscription = supabase
      .channel('teams-changes')
      .on('postgres_changes',
        { event: 'UPDATE', schema: 'public', table: 'Teams' },
        () => loadLeaderboard()
      )
      .subscribe()

    return () => subscription.unsubscribe()
  }, [])

  const loadLeaderboard = async () => {
    const { data } = await supabase
      .from('Teams')
      .select('id, name, total_score')
      .order('total_score', { ascending: false })
      .limit(10)

    setTeams(data || [])
  }

  return (
    <div className="bg-white p-6 rounded-lg">
      <h3 className="text-xl font-bold mb-4">🏆 Team Leaderboard</h3>
      <div className="space-y-2">
        {teams.map((team, index) => (
          <div
            key={team.id}
            className="flex items-center justify-between p-3 border rounded"
          >
            <div className="flex items-center gap-3">
              <span className="text-2xl font-bold text-gray-400">
                #{index + 1}
              </span>
              <span className="font-semibold">{team.name}</span>
            </div>
            <span className="text-green-600 font-bold">
              {team.total_score} pts
            </span>
          </div>
        ))}
      </div>
    </div>
  )
}

```

Real-Time Updates Explained:

- `supabase.channel()`: Creates connection to Supabase server
- Listens for changes to Teams table
- When any team's score updates, automatically re-fetches leaderboard
- **Backend (Supabase)** pushes updates to **Frontend (React)**
- Like WebSockets - maintains open connection

Step 3: Style with Medals (10 mins)

1. Add medals for top 3:

```
const getMedal = (rank) => {  
  if (rank === 0) return '🥇'  
  if (rank === 1) return '🥈'  
  if (rank === 2) return '🥉'  
  return ''  
}  
  
// In JSX:  
<span className="text-3xl">{getMedal(index)}</span>
```

Step 4: Add User Rankings (10 mins)

1. Create similar component for individual user leaderboard
2. Query Users table ordered by total_carbon (ascending - lower is better)

Checkpoint: Leaderboard shows and updates in real-time.^[1]

Day 25 (Thursday) - Progress Visualization

🕒 45 minutes

What You're Doing:

Adding charts to visualize carbon footprint trends over time using Chart.js library.^[1]

Step-by-Step Guide:

Step 1: Install Chart.js (5 mins)

1. Run: `npm install react-chartjs-2 chart.js`
2. These libraries create interactive graphs

Step 2: Create Carbon Trend Chart (25 mins)

1. Create `CarbonChart.js`:

```
import { Line } from 'react-chartjs-2'  
import {  
  Chart as ChartJS,
```

```

    CategoryScale,
    LinearScale,
    PointElement,
    LineElement,
    Title,
    Tooltip,
    Legend
  } from 'chart.js'

  // Register Chart.js components
  ChartJS.register(
    CategoryScale,
    LinearScale,
    PointElement,
    LineElement,
    Title,
    Tooltip,
    Legend
  )

  function CarbonChart({ receipts }) {
    // Prepare data for chart
    const dates = receipts.map(r => new Date(r.date).toLocaleDateString())
    const carbonValues = receipts.map(r => r.total_carbon)

    const data = {
      labels: dates,
      datasets: [{
        label: 'Carbon Footprint (kg CO2)',
        data: carbonValues,
        borderColor: 'rgb(34, 197, 94)',
        backgroundColor: 'rgba(34, 197, 94, 0.1)',
        tension: 0.4 // Curved lines
      }]
    }

    const options = {
      responsive: true,
      plugins: {
        legend: {
          position: 'top'
        },
        title: {
          display: true,
          text: 'Your Carbon Footprint Over Time'
        }
      },
      scales: {
        y: {
          beginAtZero: true,
          title: {
            display: true,
            text: 'kg CO2'
          }
        }
      }
    }
  }

```



```

    }

    return (
      <div className="bg-white p-6 rounded-lg">
        <Line data={data} options={options} />
      </div>
    )
  }
}

```

How Charts Work:

- **data:** Object containing labels (x-axis) and values (y-axis)
- **datasets:** Array of lines/bars to display
- **options:** Configuration for appearance and behavior
- **Chart.js** renders an HTML canvas element with the graph
- All happens in **frontend** - no backend needed for display

Step 3: Add to Dashboard (10 mins)

1. In Dashboard:

```

import CarbonChart from './CarbonChart'

// In JSX:
{receipts.length > 0 && <CarbonChart receipts={receipts} />}

```

Step 4: Create Team Bar Chart (5 mins)

1. Similar component using Bar instead of Line
2. Shows team members' carbon footprints side-by-side

Checkpoint: Charts display user progress with trend lines.^[1]

Day 26 (Friday) - Badge System

▮ 45 minutes

What You're Doing:

Creating achievements/badges that users earn for completing milestones.^[1]

Step-by-Step Guide:

Step 1: Define Badge Logic (15 mins)

1. Create `src/utils/badgeSystem.js`:

```

export const badges = [
  {
    id: 'first_receipt',
    name: 'First Step',

```

```

    emoji: '👤',
    description: 'Upload your first receipt',
    condition: (userStats) => userStats.receiptsCount >= 1
  },
  {
    id: 'team_player',
    name: 'Team Player',
    emoji: '👤',
    description: 'Join a team',
    condition: (userStats) => userStats.hasTeam
  },
  {
    id: 'eco_warrior',
    name: 'Eco Warrior',
    emoji: '♻️',
    description: 'Complete 10 challenges',
    condition: (userStats) => userStats.challengesCompleted >= 10
  },
  {
    id: 'planet_saver',
    name: 'Planet Saver',
    emoji: '🌱',
    description: 'Track 50kg CO2',
    condition: (userStats) => userStats.totalCarbon >= 50
  }
]

export const checkEarnedBadges = (userStats) => {
  return badges.filter(badge => badge.condition(userStats))
}

```

Step 2: Store Earned Badges (10 mins)

1. Add `user_badges` table in Supabase:
 - Columns: `id`, `user_id`, `badge_id`, `earned_at`
2. Or add `badges` JSON column to `Users` table

Step 3: Create Badge Display Component (15 mins)

1. Create `BadgeDisplay.js`:

```

function BadgeDisplay({ earnedBadges }) {
  return (
    <div className="bg-white p-6 rounded-lg">
      <h3 className="text-xl font-bold mb-4">👤 Your Badges</h3>
      <div className="grid grid-cols-2 md:grid-cols-4 gap-4">
        {earnedBadges.map(badge => (
          <div
            key={badge.id}
            className="text-center p-4 border rounded hover:shadow-lg transition"
          >
            <div className="text-5xl mb-2">{badge.emoji}</div>
            <div className="font-semibold">{badge.name}</div>
            <div className="text-xs text-gray-600">{badge.description}</div>
          </div>
        ))}
      </div>
    </div>
  )
}

```

```

    ))}
  </div>
</div>
)
}

```

Step 4: Check and Award Badges (5 mins)

1. In Dashboard, after loading user data:

```

useEffect(() => {
  const userStats = {
    receiptsCount: receipts.length,
    hasTeam: !!team,
    challengesCompleted: completedChallenges.length,
    totalCarbon: user.total_carbon
  }

  const earned = checkEarnedBadges(userStats)
  setEarnedBadges(earned)
}, [receipts, team, completedChallenges])

```

Checkpoint: Badges appear when milestones are reached.^[1]

Days 27-28 (Weekend) - OFF

Rest before final week.^[1]

Week 5: Testing & Deployment

Day 29 (Monday) - Testing & Bug Fixes

🕒 60 minutes

What You're Doing:

Testing all features, writing basic tests, and fixing any issues you find.^[1]

Step-by-Step Guide:

Step 1: Manual Testing Checklist (30 mins)

1. Create test account with different email
2. Test each flow:
 - ✓ Sign up → Login → Logout
 - ✓ Upload receipt → See analysis
 - ✓ Create team → Copy invite code
 - ✓ Join team with code (different account)

- ✓ Complete challenge → Check points
 - ✓ View leaderboard → Verify rankings
3. Test on mobile (Chrome DevTools → Toggle device toolbar)
 4. Write down any bugs you find

Step 2: Write Unit Tests (20 mins)

1. Install Jest: `npm install --save-dev @testing-library/react @testing-library/jest-dom`
2. Create `src/utils/carbonData.test.js`:

```
import { calculateTotalCarbon } from './carbonData'

test('calculates total carbon correctly', () => {
  const items = [
    { carbonPerKg: 10, quantity: 2 },
    { carbonPerKg: 5, quantity: 3 }
  ]

  const total = calculateTotalCarbon(items)
  expect(total).toBe(35) // (10*2) + (5*3) = 35
})
```

3. Run tests: `npm test`

What Testing Does:

- **Unit tests:** Test individual functions in isolation
- **Integration tests:** Test multiple components together
- **Manual testing:** Human testing actual user flows
- Catches bugs before users see them

Step 3: Fix Common Bugs (10 mins)

1. Ask Copilot: "Common bugs in React authentication flow"
2. Check for:
 - API keys not loading from `.env`
 - Infinite loops in `useEffect`
 - Database permissions (RLS policies)
 - Error handling missing

Checkpoint: All major features working, critical bugs fixed.^[1]

Day 30 (Tuesday) - Deployment & Documentation

⌚ 60 minutes

What You're Doing:

Deploying your app to the internet so anyone can use it, and creating documentation.^[1]

Step-by-Step Guide:

Step 1: Create README (15 mins)

1. Create/update README.md:

```
# EcoGuardian 🌱

Carbon footprint tracking app with gamification features.

## Features
- Receipt OCR with Google Vision API
- Carbon footprint calculation
- Team competition
- AI-generated challenges
- Real-time leaderboards

## Tech Stack
- React
- Supabase (database & auth)
- Google Vision API
- OpenAI GPT-4
- Tailwind CSS
- Chart.js

## Setup Instructions
1. Clone repository
2. Run `npm install`
3. Create `.env` file with:
   - REACT_APP_SUPABASE_URL
   - REACT_APP_SUPABASE_KEY
   - REACT_APP_OPENAI_KEY
   - REACT_APP_GOOGLE_VISION_KEY
4. Run `npm start`

## Demo
[Live Demo Link]

## Screenshots
[Add screenshots here]
```

Step 2: Push to GitHub (10 mins)

1. In terminal:

```
git add .
git commit -m "Complete EcoGuardian v1.0"
```

```
git push origin main
```

2. Make sure `.env` is in `.gitignore` (never commit API keys!)

Step 3: Deploy to Vercel (25 mins)

1. Go to vercel.com and sign up with GitHub
2. Click "New Project"
3. Import your `ecoguardian` repository
4. Configure:
 - Framework: Create React App
 - Build Command: `npm run build`
 - Output Directory: `build`
5. Add environment variables:
 - Click "Environment Variables"
 - Add all 4 API keys from your `.env`
 - These are stored securely on Vercel's servers
6. Click "Deploy"
7. Wait 2-5 minutes for build to complete
8. You'll get a URL like `ecoguardian.vercel.app`

How Deployment Works:

1. **Local Development:** Your computer runs the code
2. **GitHub:** Stores your code in the cloud
3. **Vercel:** Takes code from GitHub, builds it, and serves it to users
4. **Build Process:** Converts React code to optimized HTML/CSS/JS
5. **Backend:** Supabase still handles database; Vercel only serves the frontend

Step 4: Record Demo Video (10 mins)

1. Use Loom (free screen recorder) or OBS
2. Record 2-3 minute walkthrough:
 - Sign up
 - Upload receipt
 - Show carbon analysis
 - Create/join team
 - View leaderboard
3. Upload to YouTube or embed in README

Checkpoint: ☐ Project live on the internet! ^[1]

Key Concepts Summary

Frontend vs Backend

- **Frontend:** Everything in the browser (React components, UI, user interactions)
- **Backend:** Server-side operations (Supabase database, Google Vision API, OpenAI API)
- Your app is **frontend-heavy** with **backend services** handling data and AI

SQL & Databases

- **SQL:** Language for talking to databases (SELECT, INSERT, UPDATE, DELETE)
- **Supabase:** PostgreSQL database with JavaScript wrapper
- You write JavaScript; Supabase converts to SQL automatically
- Example: `.from('Users').select('*')` → `SELECT * FROM Users`

API Calls

- **API:** Application Programming Interface - way for apps to communicate
- **Request:** Your app sends data to external service
- **Response:** Service sends back result
- **Authentication:** API keys prove you're allowed to use the service

Real-Time Updates

- **WebSocket:** Persistent connection between browser and server
- Supabase sends notifications when data changes
- React re-renders components automatically
- Enables live leaderboard without refreshing page

Environment Variables

- `.env` **file:** Stores secret configuration
- `process.env`: JavaScript way to access these values
- Never commit `.env` to GitHub
- Deploy platforms (Vercel) have secure storage for these

Troubleshooting Guide

"Module not found" Error

Problem: Library not installed

Solution: `npm install <library-name>`

".env variables are undefined"

Problem: React only reads variables starting with `REACT_APP_`

Solution: Rename variables or restart development server

"CORS error" when calling API

Problem: Browser blocking requests to different domain

Solution: Use backend proxy or CORS-enabled API

Supabase query returns empty

Problem: Row Level Security (RLS) policies blocking access

Solution: Check Supabase dashboard → Authentication → Policies

Image not uploading to Supabase Storage

Problem: Storage permissions or file size

Solution: Check storage policies and compress images

Real-time not working

Problem: Subscription not properly set up

Solution: Verify `.channel()` and `.subscribe()` calls

Additional Resources

Learning

- React Docs: react.dev
- Supabase Docs: supabase.com/docs
- MDN Web Docs: developer.mozilla.org

When Stuck

1. Check browser console (F12)
2. Read error message carefully
3. Ask Copilot with error message
4. Search error on Stack Overflow
5. Check library documentation

6. Ask in Discord communities

Communities

- r/reactjs on Reddit
- Reactiflux Discord
- Supabase Discord
- Stack Overflow

You've got this! Take it one day at a time, use AI tools to help, and celebrate each checkpoint. The goal is learning and building, not perfection. ^[1]

✱

1. EcoGuardian-30-Day-Development-Plan.pdf